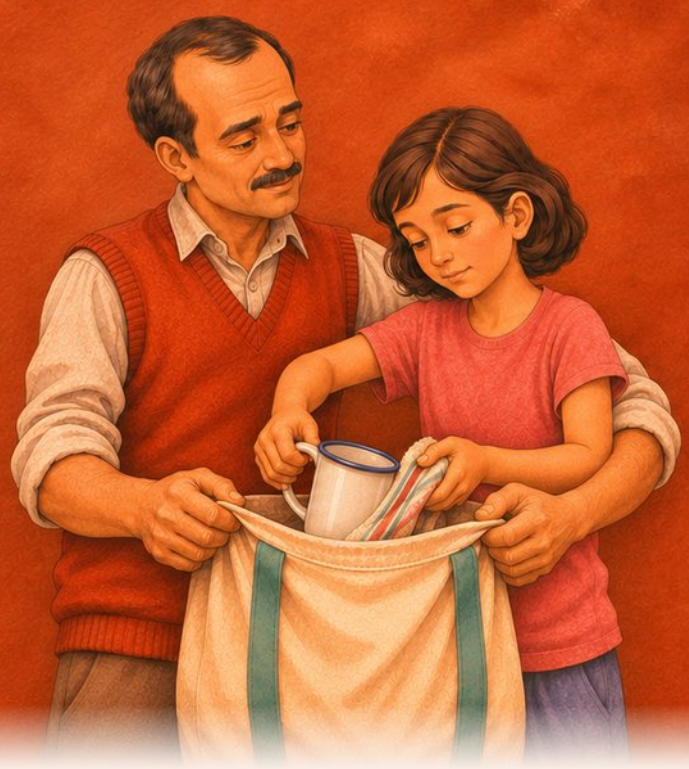
AFTER A DISTRESSING EXPERIENCE

Every family's next step is different

Some families are going home, some are moving somewhere new, and some are still waiting. You may feel relief, sadness, worry or anger, sometimes all at once. Even a familiar place may not feel the same.





1 Going home

Before entering a damaged home, ask your ward office how to get a safety check of the house and land. If you are not sure it is safe, do not go in. Go with someone you trust, if you can.



2 Moving somewhere new

You may miss your old home, even in a safe new place. Give yourself time. If it feels right, talk with the people you stay with about sharing space and daily tasks.



3 Still waiting

Not knowing what comes next is hard. Ask the person in charge of your shelter, or your ward office:

- ? What is known?
- ? What is not decided yet?
- ? When can I ask again?

You do not have to manage alone

Choose what is possible for you today. If you need food, safe water, medicines or a place to stay, ask a worker to help you find support. If your medicines are lost or running out, ask a health worker how to continue them safely.

Wherever you are staying



Home is more than a building
You may miss neighbours, work, familiar places and memories. These losses matter. Spend time with someone you trust, if you wish.



Worried when it rains?
Ask local responders about warnings and a safer place to go. If a warning comes, act on it straight away.



Worried about money or work?
Ask your ward office what help you can apply for, what you need, and who can help you apply. Take someone you trust if it helps.



Make time for children
Tell them what you know, and say when you do not know. Keep safe play and familiar routines. Do not punish children for being frightened or upset.

Ask for help early

Feelings getting worse, not going away, or making daily life hard? Talk to a health worker. You do not have to wait.

Get help now

In danger, or thinking of harming yourself? Get help now. Ask a health worker or responder, and ask someone you trust to stay with you.

Help near you: _____ (filled in and checked locally)

Look after yourself. Look after each other.

Support is for everyone, including people with disabilities and older people. Ask for large print or more time.

Sources: WHO, Psychological First Aid: Guide for Field Workers (2011); IASC, Guidelines on MHPSS in Emergency Settings (2007), Action Sheets 8.1–8.2; IFRC Psychosocial Centre, Mental health and psychosocial impacts of flooding.

Take-home leaflet · A4 · Chapter 5 of 6 · English review draft · Not for field distribution. Fictional illustrations, AI-assisted and developed under human direction.